

URI Gaming Club Website Project Summary

Overview and Features

This website, built using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and PHP, is designed to give users the ability to access all relevant information about the URI Gaming Club. It has four pages: Homepage, Events, Calendar and Feedback. The Homepage features a main content section with basic information about the club, including overview, location and what we have, meeting and events, and how to join. It also features a sub column with a JavaScript powered interest button, connection information, and the current E-Board for the club.

The events page features information on all of the club's weekly and special events: Weekly Game Night, Rhody Rumble Weekly, Rhody Ruckus Monthly, RhodyFest, and Sugar Rush. This page is populated from a MySQL database which contains all of the event information, and can be easily updated by simply changing the fields in the database itself. The event card color is different depending on whether the event is open to the public or just for students, with pink designating it as open to the public.

The calendar page has two main features: the calendar and the event results viewer. The calendar is an embed of the Google Calendar connected to the Gaming Club email for easy updating. If events are put on the calendar, they will be reflected on the site itself. The tournament result viewer features a dropdown menu with the names of all of the URI Weekly Super Smash Bros tournaments from the 25-26 school year. When clicked, an API Post request is sent to the [Start.gg](https://start.gg) API, the site where our tournaments are hosted, which retrieves and writes the top 3 placing players at the tournament to the page. If the event does not have results it says "No results yet".

The final page is the feedback form, which features seven required questions: first and last name, email, age, URI student status, interested events, and other feedback. This information, once validated by a PHP file, can be posted directly into the MySQL database for viewing. If a user has already filled out the form, (confirmed via email), their previous response will be updated with any new information. This page also features an information deletion request form, which will remove feedback from the database if the email entered is in it. This allows for users to remove their data if they decide they want to.

Maintenance

Each page has slightly different ways to update information, which have been briefly explained in the previous section but I will go into more detail here. For the

homepage, all relevant information can be changed by editing the HTML file. All of the information is held in simple paragraph elements (<p>), and the links are held in <a href> elements. Here is a resource to learn more about [paragraphs](#) and [links](#) in HTML.

The events page, as mentioned before, can be updated directly by adding, removing, or updating events in the MySQL database. This database will need to be hosted on some kind of server, as its current server will be shut down once I graduate. Information on MySQL databases can be found [here](#).

The Google Calendar part of the calendar page is very simple to update: just log into the Gaming Club Google Account, go to the calendar, and populate it with whatever events you want. These will be reflected on the calendar on the site, and users can add events to their own Google calendars. The API section is a bit more challenging, as it involves making a query to the [Start.gg](#) API, whose documentation can be accessed [here](#). This [JavaScript API tutorial](#) can reinforce the basics for anyone attempting to update the full structure. To simply add more events in this same format, just add a new event to the option menu with the format “<option value=“uri-rhody-rumble-{number}”>URI Rhody Rumble {number}</option>”, where the number is the bracket number (without the curly braces).

Finally, the form page populates the database on its own, but if you wanted to add more questions or change existing ones you’d have to change the questions on the PHP page itself, add validation with the existing validation features, and then add or update the category on the MySQL database end. The form itself is an HTML form, and a guide to working with them can be found [here](#). Validation can be understood by viewing this [tutorial](#). This is easily the most complex part of the site, so assistance from an experienced web developer may prove helpful (there are plenty of Computer Science majors in the Gaming Club so it shouldn’t be that hard to find one).

Each page file is clearly labeled, visual CSS files are in the CSS folder, and JavaScript files are in the JS folder, so navigating the codebase should be simple. The code is structured in a standard fashion with comments denoting what each section is for, as well as comments at the top from what was added/changed. The project’s GitHub repository has a pretty extensive commit history, although the commit messages could have been a bit more specific in some cases. Overall it should still be pretty simple to work with.

Lessons Learned and Future Improvements

Working on this project in conjunction with the URI Gaming Club was a wonderful experience, and I learned a lot about making a site to someone else’s vision, not just your own. Presenting my work to a group that has a certain expectation was a little stressful, but the consistent cooperation from the President and Vice President allowed

us to create something that could genuinely be useful to the club. If another aspiring developer came along and wanted to continue improving the site, several things including a more advanced API call structure, maybe even on its own designated results page, a photo gallery, which was in the original plan but we didn't have nearly enough pictures to make it work, and other changes the club members would like to see could be added. You can access the project's GitHub Repository [here](#), and clone it to make any changes you wish. Happy developing!